Lesson 09: Reading: Festivals, with Reading Strategies

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

Adapted from People and Places - An Intermediate Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College (CC BY-NC-SA 4.0): 2.4: Reading an ESL Reader: BC Festivals; 2.5: Reading Strategies: BC Festivals.

In this lesson

You will read "All Together Now: BC Festivals", a short text about four festivals in British Columbia, Canada. You will build your vocabulary, guess new words from their suffixes, find the topic of each paragraph, and review capital letters. (The text and activities come from BC Reads: Adult Literacy Fundamental English by Shantel Ivits, BCcampus, CC BY 4.0.)

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Find the topic of each paragraph in a reading.
- Keep a record of new words with a definition and an example sentence.
- Use the suffixes -er, -or, -ar and -est to guess the meaning of new words.
- Use capital letters for names, titles, places, dates, events and the word "I".
- Retell a short reading in your own words.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
festival	a special event, often every year, when people celebrate something	the Pacific Rim Whale Festival
celebrate	do something special and happy for an important event	festivals that celebrate the things that make their hometown special
journey	a long trip from one place to another	one of the longest yearly journeys of any mammal
kilometre	1,000 metres (US spelling: kilometer)	The whole trip is about 16,000 kilometres.
mammal	an animal that feeds its babies with milk; whales and people are mammals	mammals of a different sort: people in bathtub boats
national	of a whole country	Pacific Rim National Park
championship	a competition to find the best player or team	Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race
ceremony	special, formal actions for an important event	a ceremony to awaken the dragon

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
sculpture	art made from stone, wood, snow and so on	a BC snow sculpture contest
suffix	letters at the end of a word that change its meaning	drum → drummer
topic	what a paragraph is about	The Vernon Winter Carnival

Rules and explanations

Build your vocabulary

- Your vocabulary is the group of words that you know. Keep track of new words from newspapers, TV and readings. Find out what they mean. Then remember and use them.
- A **Vocab Builder** box has five parts: the word (in the middle), the dictionary definition, a definition in your own words, a sentence with the word, and a drawing. A dictionary gives the most common meaning first.

Word attack: suffixes

You can often guess a new word without a dictionary. Look for a **suffix**: letters at the end of a word that change its meaning.

- **-er, -or, -ar** often mean "a person who": a baker bakes, an actor acts, a liar lies. In the story: racers, visitors, drummer, co-worker.
- Not every word that ends in -er is a person: water and winter are also in the story.
- **-est** means "the most": fastest, strongest, lightest. In the story: longest, oldest, largest. ("The most fast" only explains the meaning. We always say "the fastest".)

Finding the topic

The subject of the reading is festivals of British Columbia. It has six paragraphs. Each paragraph has its own topic: the one thing that the whole paragraph is about. A topic is not too general (for example, the whole reading) and not too small (one detail).

Capital letters

Use a capital letter at the start of a sentence, and for:

1. names of people
2. titles of books, movies, newspapers and so on
3. places and landmarks
4. days of the week and months of the year
5. holidays and special events
6. the word "I"

> **Note for Arabic speakers**

- Arabic script has no capital letters, so English capitals are easy to forget. Check names, places, days, months and "I".
- Arabic often makes related words by changing the pattern inside the word. English often adds a suffix at the end (visit → visitor, drum → drummer), so look at the end of a new word.

Practice

1. Before you read. Think about festivals you have been to. What did they celebrate? What kinds of events were there? Tell your tutor. Then read "All Together Now: BC Festivals" in your lesson material (section 2.4).

2. Why learn new words? Learning new words helps you because ..... (Choose all that apply.)

- a) you will understand more difficult readings
- b) you will be able to express yourself more clearly
- c) you will be able to retell things in your own words

3. Vocabulary. Which of these words are new to you? tradition, celebrate, journey, kilometre, mammal, national, championship, ceremony, festival, sculpture. Choose three. For each word, draw a Vocab Builder box on paper (or print the book's worksheet, see "Watch online") and complete all five parts.

4. Word attack. Complete the sentences.

- a) A visitor is a person who ..... .
- b) A racer is a person who ..... .
- c) A sculptor is a person who ..... .
- d) Longest means the most ..... .
- e) Oldest means the most ..... .
- f) Largest means the most ..... .

5. Find the topic. Choose the topic of each paragraph.

- a) Paragraph 2: Whales / Festivals in British Columbia / The Pacific Rim Whale Festival
- b) Paragraph 3: Bathtubs / Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race / Vancouver Island
- c) Paragraph 4: The Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver / Dragons / China
- d) Paragraph 5: The Vernon Winter Carnival / Sculptures / The Rocky Mountains

6. Fill in the blanks. Use the word bank: cultures, journey, jail, serious.

- a) The Pacific Rim Whale Festival celebrates the ..... of the grey whale.
- b) The World Championship Bathtub Race started as a silly event but is now a ..... sport.
- c) The Dragon Boat Festival celebrates the many different ..... of the people in Vancouver.
- d) At the Vernon Winter Carnival, people are put in ..... to raise money.

7. Why do these words have capital letters? Match each word to a rule (1-6) in "Capital letters": Arctic, Mexico, Expo 86, Rocky Mountains, Nanaimo, March, Vernon Winter Carnival, Dragon Boat Festival, China, February, Pacific Rim National Park.

8. Add the capital letters. Rewrite the sentences.

- a) albert ostman said he was kidnapped by a sasquatch.
- b) ginger goodwin hid on alone mountain near comox lake.
- c) there is a movie about bill miner called the grey fox.
- d) are you going to the kamloopa powwow?
- e) yes, i am leaving on friday, and i will be back on sunday.

Speak with your tutor

- "I will retell 'All Together Now: BC Festivals' in my own words, one festival at a time. After each one, ask me a question about it."
- "Ask me about a festival in my hometown: what it celebrates, when it is, and what people do there."
- "Give me ten verbs, one at a time. I will say the word for the person who does it (for example, visit → visitor). Correct my word and spelling."
- "Ask me about my city with superlatives: What is the oldest building? The largest park? The longest street?"

Read aloud

1. FES·ti·val
2. CEL·e·brate
3. tra·DI·tion
4. JOUR·ney
5. CHAM·pi·on·ship
6. CER·e·mo·ny
7. SCULP·ture
8. ki·LOM·e·tre (also KIL·o·me·tre; dictionaries differ)
9. What did they celebrate? (↘)
10. Are you going to the Kamloopa Powwow? (↗)

Writing task

Think of a festival you know about. Make a poster or an advertisement to tell people about the event. You can also invent your own festival.

- Include: the name of the festival, details about the events, the dates and the address. You can make up details, such as where and when the next one will take place.
- When you finish, check your capital letters and use a dictionary to check your spelling.

- Type it and show it to your tutor. Ask the tutor to check the capital letters and to ask you one question about your festival.

Watch online

- Vocab Builder worksheet (the book's link): https://opentextbc.ca/abealf3/wp-content/uploads/sites/95/2015/04/Vocab-Builder.pdf
- The original story and activities, BC Reads (BCcampus): https://opentextbc.ca/abealf3/chapter/all-together-now-bc-festivals/

Answer key

1. (example answer) I went to a spring festival in my town. It celebrated the new season. There was music, food and a market.
2. All three: a, b and c.
3. (example answer) Word: journey. Dictionary definition: a trip from one place to another, especially a long one. My own words: a long trip. Sentence: The grey whales make a long journey from Mexico to the Arctic. Drawing: a map with an arrow.
4. a) visits b) races c) sculpts (makes sculptures) d) long e) old f) large (BC Reads answer key)
5. a) The Pacific Rim Whale Festival b) Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race c) The Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver d) The Vernon Winter Carnival (BC Reads answer key)
6. a) journey b) serious c) cultures d) jail (BC Reads answer key)
7. Places and landmarks (3): Arctic, Mexico, Rocky Mountains, Nanaimo, China, Pacific Rim National Park. Months (4): March, February. Holidays and special events (5): Expo 86, Vernon Winter Carnival, Dragon Boat Festival (BC Reads answer key).
8. (BC Reads answer key)
    - a) Albert Ostman said he was kidnapped by a sasquatch.
    - b) Ginger Goodwin hid on Alone Mountain near Comox Lake.
    - c) There is a movie about Bill Miner called The Grey Fox.
    - d) Are you going to the Kamloopa Powwow?
    - e) Yes, I am leaving on Friday, and I will be back on Sunday.

My notes